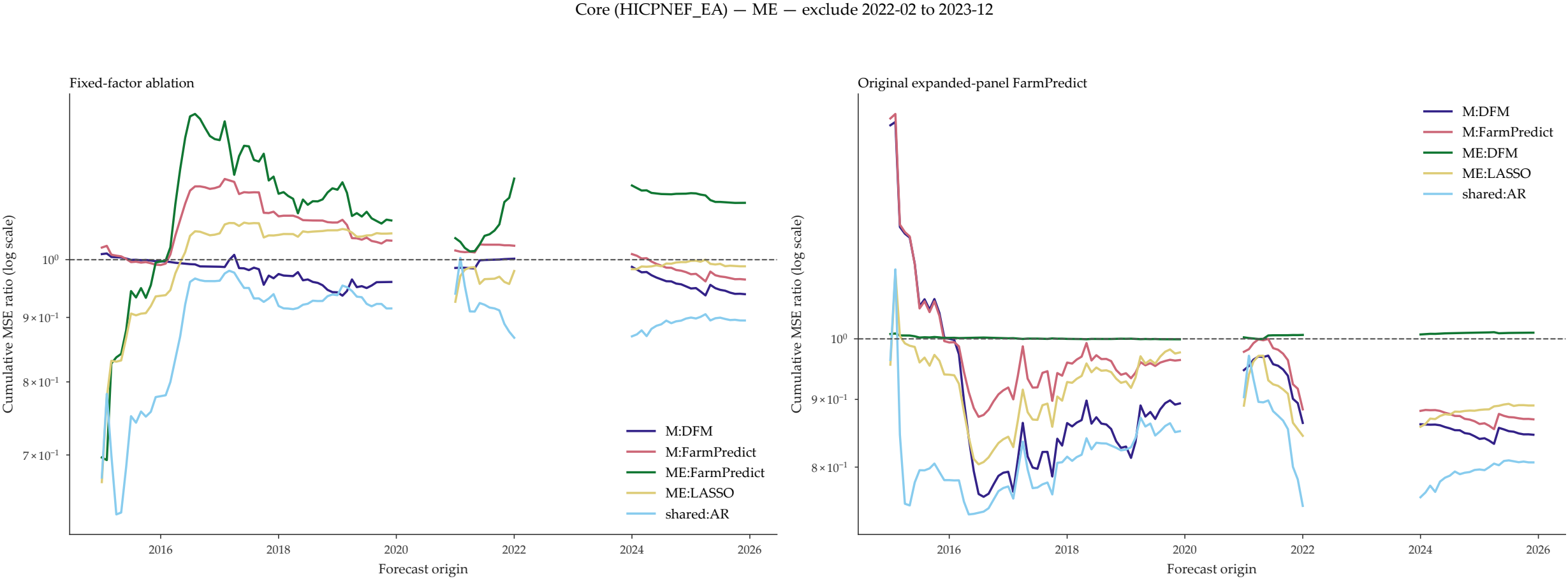


Notes: 97 matched dates; 2020 and the stated crisis window excluded; target months through 2025-12.
Ratio = named panel forecast / benchmark; below 1 favors the numerator. FarmPredict here means DFM + LASSO.
Ablation fixes M factors and adds E residuals to the sparse stage. Training and saved forecasts unchanged.
Gaps do not reset accumulation or connect curves. Source: saved cold paper run and fixed-factor ablations.